

TPT Brand Refresh Visual Guidelines

V2.0 August 2023



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As pensions specialists we innovate and adapt, able to uniquely shape around you. Building better futures, we provide a structure for your goals. Our brand refresh is based upon the concept of being **Shaped Around You** – this gives us an underlying foundation we can build from, with new and existing elements adding harmony, balance and a cohesive visual style to our communications.

These guidelines outline the key principles of the TPT brand identity and how we apply them.

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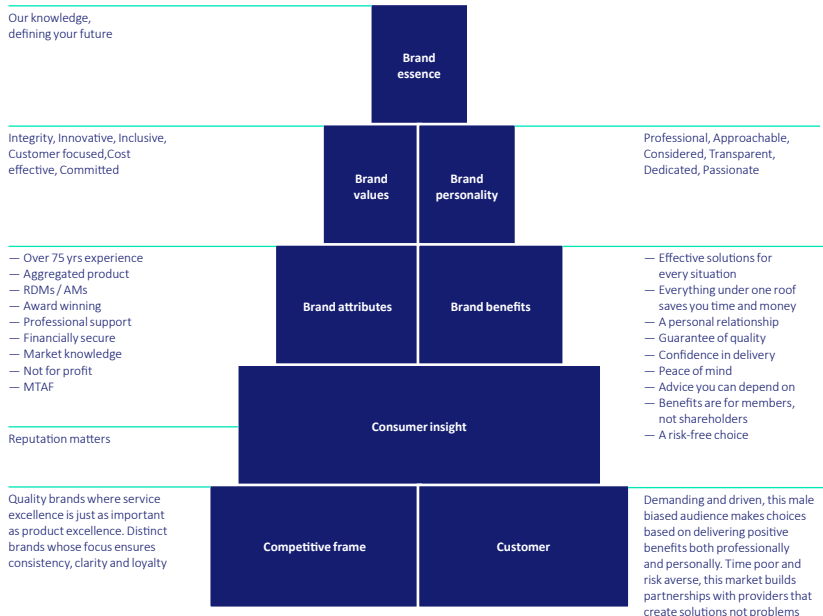
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Our brand

Brand pyramid

This pyramid includes the many different elements that make up our brand and illustrates the steps clients go through to connect with TPT.



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Make membership worthwhile.

To help us achieve this, we have a set of values that give clarity to our purpose and guidance for our actions:

Committed

We are engaged.

We keep promises and meet our customers' expectations.

We are persistent in our pursuit of success.

Cost effective

We always look for good use of resources.

We budget fairly and robustly.

We act competitively.

Customer focused

We offer a very high level of service.

We listen to and learn from our customers.

We are friendly, approachable, supportive, understanding and responsive.

Inclusive

We establish partnerships with customers.

We embrace diversity in all that we do.

We work towards one goal and one vision.

Innovative

We challenge current processes or traditional methods.

We act pro-actively and creatively.

We encourage and accept new ideas.

Integrity

We consider the interests of others and respect their views.

We are fair in all of our dealings.

We offer the option of ethical investments.

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Logo

Due to the flexible nature of the TPT design language the logo that best suits the application should be selected.

We should use our primary logo on light backgrounds and on dark backgrounds we revert to a mono version of our primary logo.

Where reproduction constraints dictate we should use our mono logo in TPT Blue or black.

Primary logo



Retirement Solutions

Mono logo



Retirement Solutions



Retirement Solutions



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It is important to allow sufficient clear space around our logo and to ensure that it is never used at less than the minimum permitted size.



t|p|t

Retirement Solutions

←25mm→

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Incorrect use

Distorting the logo, adding effects, changing the colour or font or positioning over imagery is forbidden as it weakens the brand.



Do not distort
the proportions



Do not change
the font



Do not change
the colours



Do not use
transparency effects



Do not
apply effects



Do not use colour logo
on photography

Primary colour palette

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Our chosen brand colours suggest solidity, reliability and trust and therefore must be used consistently and without amendments or additions.

As a rule one of the three bold primary palette colours (Blue, Fuchsia and Turquoise) should be used as the key anchoring colour.

We have introduced additional complimentary colour of Pale Fuchsia as part of a refreshed primary palette, helping to create variety, interest and categorisation.

TPT Fuchsia

C42 M100 Y0 K0
R165 G24 B144
#A51890

TPT Blue

C100 M98 Y0 K15
R21 G31 B109
#151F6D

TPT Turquoise

C70 M0 Y45 K0
R65 G226 B186
#41E2BA

TPT Pale Fuchsia

C5 M25 Y0 K0
R237 G209 B233
#EDD1E9

White

R255 G255 B255
#FFFFFF

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Secondary palette

Tints should only be used in increments of 20% on graphical elements such as tables, charts and graphs.

TPT Fuchsia 100%	80% C36 M83 Y0 K0 R183 G70 B166	60% C42 M100 Y0 K0 R201 G166 B144	40% C25 M67 Y0 K0 R219 G163 B211	20% C5 M25 Y0 K0 R237 G209 B233
TPT Blue 100%	80% C86 M75 Y11 K1 R68 G76 B138	60% C63 M52 Y11 K0 R115 G121 B167	40% C42 M34 Y9 K0 R161 G165 B197	20% C22 M16 Y5 K0 R208 G210 B226
TPT Turquoise 100%	80% C63 M0 Y38 K0 R103 G232 B200	60% C52 M0 Y30 K0 R141 G238 B214	40% C38 M0 Y21 K0 R179 G243 B227	20% C21 M0 Y11 K0 R217 G249 B241
Black 50%	40% C0 M0 Y0 K40 R178 G178 B178	30% C0 M0 Y0 K30 R198 G198 B198	20% C0 M0 Y0 K20 R218 G218 B218	10% C0 M0 Y0 K10 R237 G237 B237

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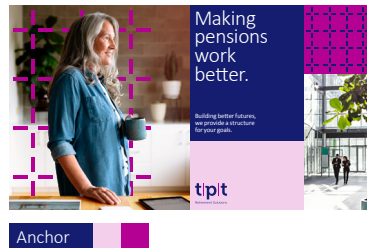
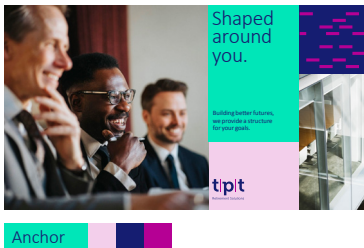
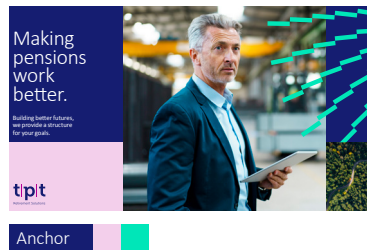
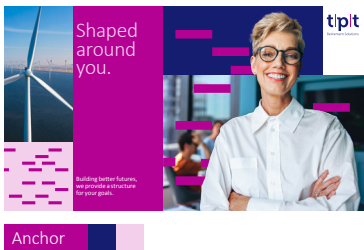
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It is important to think of our palette beyond single applications. Whilst we should ensure we have a good balance of colour in a single application, the graphic identity works best when we allow flexibility and view our brand holistically.

The following show examples of how we can flex the palette across applications. The visuals show a sample swatch breakdown to demonstrate how the key anchoring colour effects the design.



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Colour combinations

Our colours have been chosen to work in tandem with each other, but to ensure legibility there are combinations we should avoid in certain scenarios.

Text

To ensure legibility follow the below combinations in application.

Navy	×
Turquoise	×
White	✓
Pale Fuchsia	✓

Turquoise	✓
White	✓
Pale Fuchsia	✓

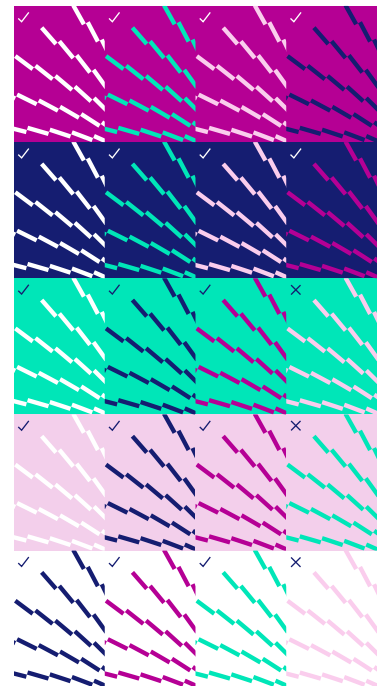
Navy	✓
White	×
Pale Fuchsia	×

Navy	✓
White	×
Turquoise	×
Fuchsia	✓

Navy	✓
Pale Fuchsia	×
Turquoise	×
Fuchsia	✓

Pattern

The below colour combinations should be followed to ensure contrast and avoid colour clashes.



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Available in a range of weights and styles, Calibri is a clean and contemporary humanist sans-serif typeface. Calibri should be used in all branded materials and communications.

Calibri Light has been added as part of the brand refresh – we should use this for body and headlines, with Regular and Bold serving to highlight key information.

If Calibri isn't available or doesn't display on a device, Tahoma is used.

We should avoid type sizes that become difficult to read. A minimum body copy size of 8pt for print and 14pt for digital applications should be considered.

Calibri Light

AaBbCcDdEeFfGgHhIiJjKkLlMmNn
OoPpQqRrSsTtUuVvWwXxYyZz
0123456789

Aa

Calibri Regular

AaBbCcDdEeFfGgHhIiJjKkLlMmNn
OoPpQqRrSsTtUuVvWwXxYyZz
0123456789

Aa

Calibri Bold

AaBbCcDdEeFfGgHhIiJjKkLlMmNn
OoPpQqRrSsTtUuVvWwXxYyZz
0123456789

Aa

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The following example demonstrates how we can properly set type within modules using our grid.

All type should be left aligned, but we can vertically justify to the top, centre or bottom of the module.

We should allow for a small amount of internal padding in these text modules. This is defined by dividing the point size of the main headline by four. i.e. a 32pt headline would equal 8pt padding.

Top justification

Pension funds
shaped around you

Centre justification

Pension funds
shaped around you

Bottom justification

Pension funds
shaped around you

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Our graphic strip is a simple device that helps add clarity, hierarchy and guidance through communications.

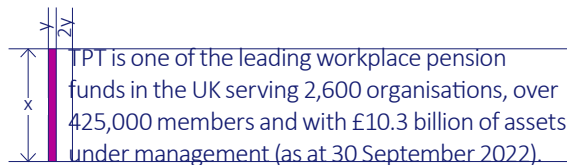
For consistency, the graphic strip should be set in TPT Fuchsia.

The height of the strip is defined by the text it accompanies as shown – from cap height to baseline of copy.

The minimum size is defined by the height of two lines of copy – i.e. we should not have a graphic strip that is only one line tall.

We can also use the graphic strip with introductory copy as shown. It should again be set to the height of the paragraph.

We should avoid using the strip to connect headlines and supporting copy.



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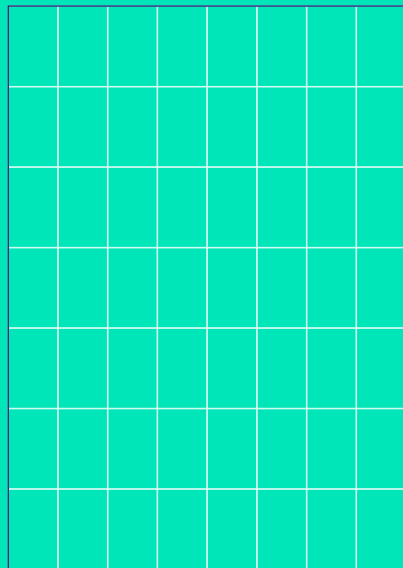
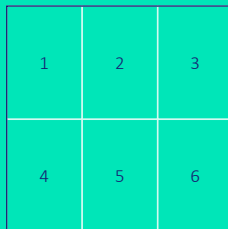
Grids and guides

Our visual identity begins with a grid that adds harmony and balance – it's an underlying foundation we can build from. An ever evolving structure with endless variation and possibility that echoes our values and helps to tell compelling stories.

The grid is based upon a simple 3×2 square format as shown. This is then expanded across the page until it 'snaps' to an edge. We can then stretch either horizontally or vertically.

Below is a suggested column structure for some common formats

A5	6×5
A4	8×7
A3	10×9
A4 (Landscape)	11×5
16×9	16×6



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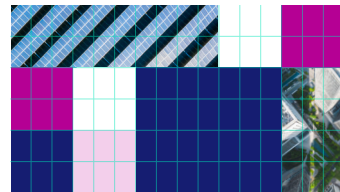
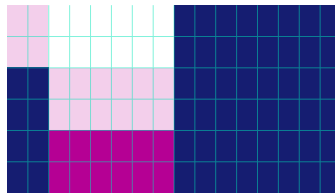
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Shown are examples of how this structure can flex – from simple to more complex – and how we can begin to integrate imagery, pattern and typography.



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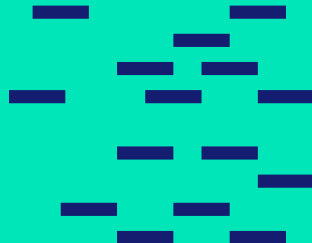
Pattern

We have introduced a set of ownable illustrative patterns which we can use to add texture and interest. These are inspired by key brand values and the TPT graphic strip device.

These patterns have been created in a range of colourways from the TPT palette. Please refer to page 14 for guidance on colour combinations.

We should avoid mixing patterns on a single page.

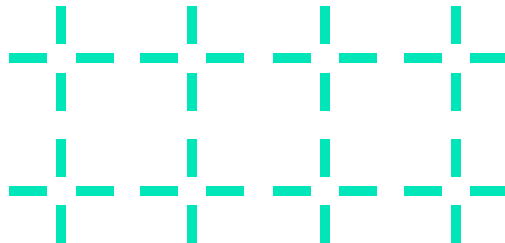
Progress



Future facing



Connecting



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Patterns in use

Our patterns can be used both contained within a frame, or breaking out and interacting with imagery.

Both approaches add interest to our communications, with the expressive use more suitable to hero applications such as adverts or website headers, and contained pattern providing texture and detail.

When applying a pattern it should feel like we're just glimpsing a small portion of a much larger connected pattern.

Expressive



Contained



Patterns – what to avoid

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Our patterns can be used flexibly at both small and super-size. There are however some ways in which we should try to avoid their application.

01. Over enlarging the pattern

If we increase the pattern to a size that is too large we lose definition and it becomes too abstract.

02. Not cropping

We should crop carefully to show interesting segments and avoid reproducing the pattern in its entirety.

03. Obscuring imagery

The pattern should be a compliment to imagery and not overpower them. If using cut-outs the pattern should sit in a layer behind the subject.



Bringing it together

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Our graphic system has been created to give maximum flexibility whilst retaining consistency. Using our grid structure as a framework we can add our graphic elements to create cohesive visual communications. The example shown demonstrates the principles of how we can combine colour, imagery, pattern and typography.

The key to these layouts is striking a balance between all of the elements. Whilst there is no set amount of blocks, we should avoid applications being too sparse or busy. A guide of 3–6 for an A-size page is advisable.

The brand works best when we keep elements simple, minimal and with breathing space around key elements.

Headline

Set in Calibri Light

Supporting copy

Additional copy can be set in Calibri Light or Regular.

Imagery

We should contain images within a frame, but can also break out key details as in the example shown.



Pattern

Can be both contained or break out of the frame.

TPT master logo
Refer to sizing and spacing guides.

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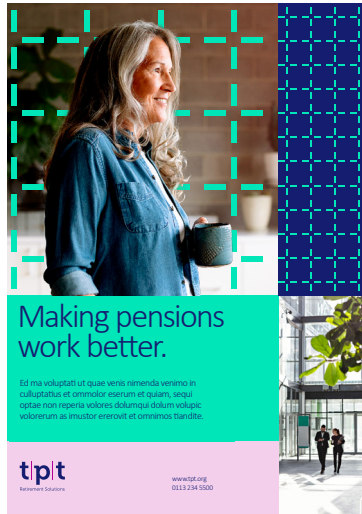
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The following examples show how we can use our flexible brand elements to create variations of advertising material.



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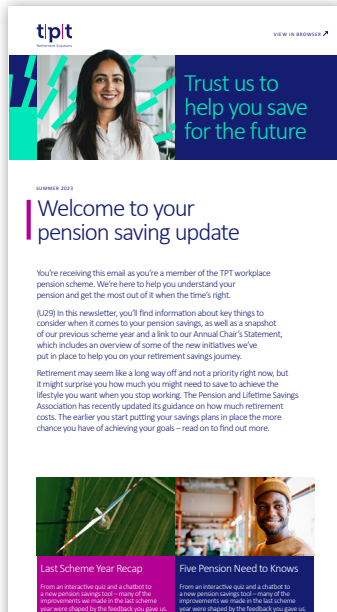
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Again, we can use our brand elements to create rich email correspondents.



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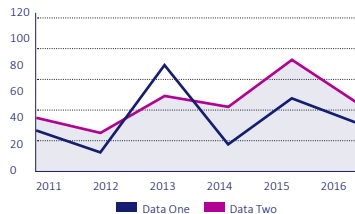
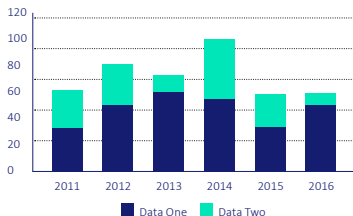
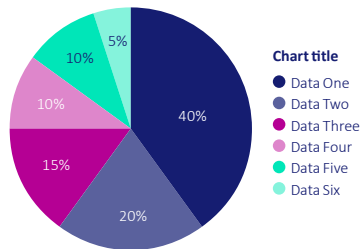
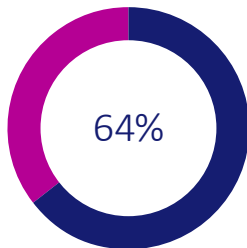
All tables should be created using the correct brand colours and typefaces. They should be simple and easy to understand.

The example is shown as a guide, but we have flexibility when using colour, for example the 'Total' bar could be TPT Fuchsia, or key information could be highlighted with an alternative colour.

Fund	The trust	Benchmark	Variance	The trust	Benchmark	Variance
Quoted equities	(1.1)	(0.1)	(1.0)	9.1	9.3	(0.2)
Global equity fund	(1.1)	(2.1)	1.0	9.0	9.2	(0.2)
Passive global equity fund	(1.1)	(2.1)	1.0	9.0	9.2	(0.2)
Passive emerging markets equity fund	(1.1)	(2.1)	1.0	9.0	9.2	(0.2)
SRI Global Equity Fund	(1.1)	(2.1)	1.0	9.0	9.2	(0.2)
Alternative Liquid Assets	(1.1)	(2.1)	1.0	9.0	9.2	(0.2)
Emerging Markets Debt	(1.1)	(2.1)	1.0	9.0	9.2	(0.2)
Alternative Illiquid Assets	(1.1)	(2.1)	1.0	9.0	9.2	(0.2)
Absolute Return	(1.1)	(2.1)	1.0	9.0	9.2	(0.2)
Emerging Markets Debt	(1.1)	(0.1)	(1.0)	9.1	9.3	(0.2)
Alternative Illiquid Assets	(1.1)	(2.1)	1.0	9.0	9.2	(0.2)
Distressed Debt	(1.1)	(2.1)	1.0	9.0	9.2	(0.2)
Total	8.3	8.3	8.3	8.3	10.3	80.4

Graphs & charts

All graphs should be created using the correct brand colours and typefaces. They should be simple and easy to understand.



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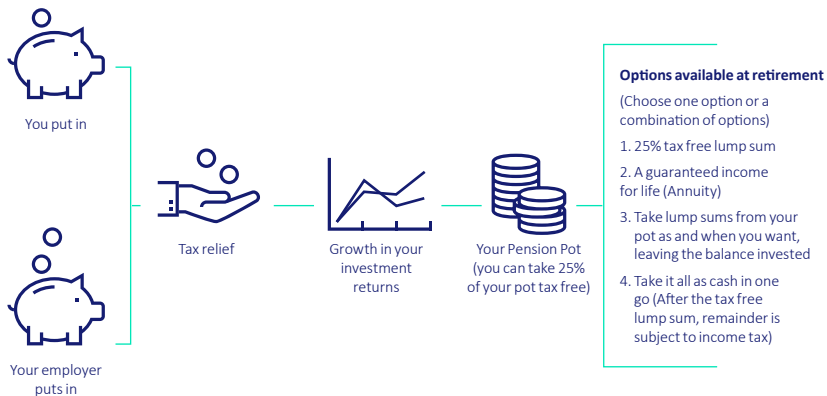
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All diagrams should be created using the correct brand colours and typefaces. They should be simple and easy to understand.



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Icons

Clear iconography plays a big part of the TPT brand with each icon should be created via the template provided.

We should always maintain a consistent stroke width.

Icons can be displayed in all of the colours in our palette, but we should always ensure we have good visibility against backgrounds.

Please refer to page 14 for guidance on colour combinations.



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N.B. All imagery within this presentation is for Client's internal reference purposes and is not cleared for any external facing usage. Any external use of the imagery will require licensing. Agency cannot be responsible or held liable in the event of Client's non-compliance of the limited intended use.

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Our photography style is warm, natural and authentic. We want to capture real scenarios and genuine moments of emotion. These should be of people carrying out everyday actions captured naturally. Images which utilise natural light help to convey an authentic and friendly style of photography.

Portraits can be both posed or reportage, with the key principle of the images having a sense of reality being universal.

We can also show how our work is connected to the wider world with a secondary environment photography style.

With all our imagery we should ensure we show the diversity of people and locations that represent our partners, clients and employees.



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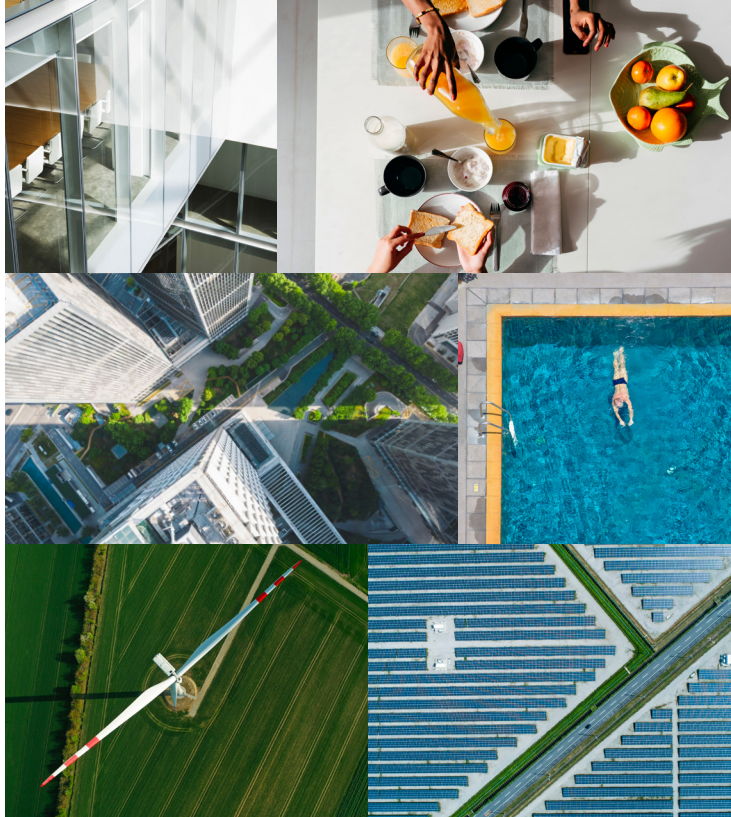
In application

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Our supporting environment photography style shows how we are connected to the wider world. These can emphasise our commitment to sustainable business practices or how our products help customers achieve their goals. Our aim is to give our work context.

When choosing imagery we should try to show surprising angles or points of view and avoid shots that feels overtly like stock imagery.



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Our sub-brands use all of the elements of our master brand, but we adjust the use of colour and pattern to give them their own distinctive look and feel.

The following pages demonstrate the key differences in brand specific patterns, expressive use of the pattern and colour balance of applications.

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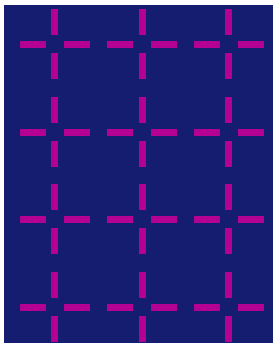
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Colour mix



Brand specific pattern



Expressive use of pattern

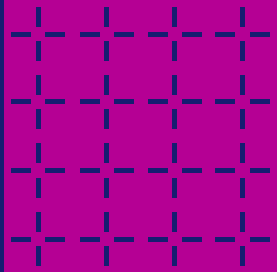




Making pensions work better.

Building better futures,
we provide a structure
for your goals.

tp|t
Retirement Solutions





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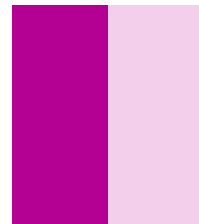
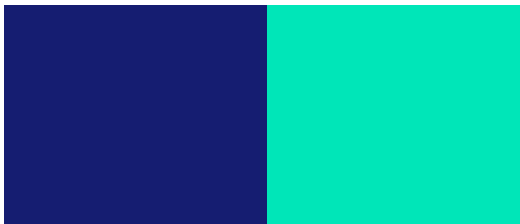
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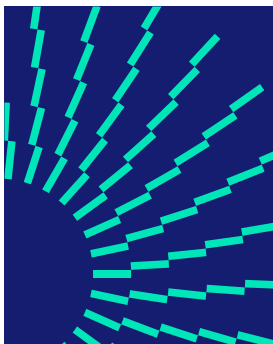
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Brand specific pattern



Expressive use of pattern



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we provide a structure
for your goals.



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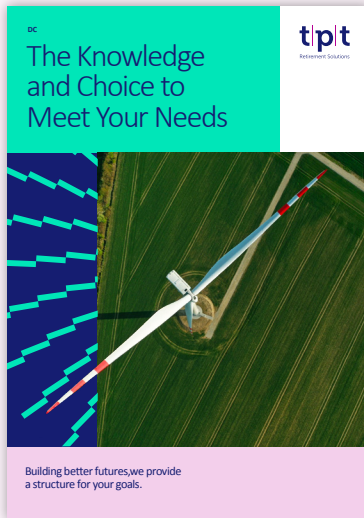
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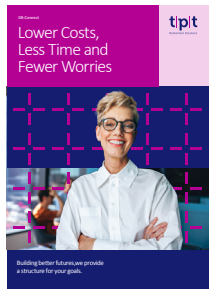
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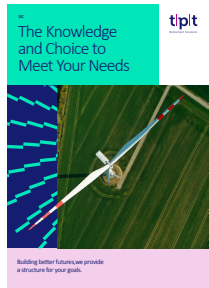
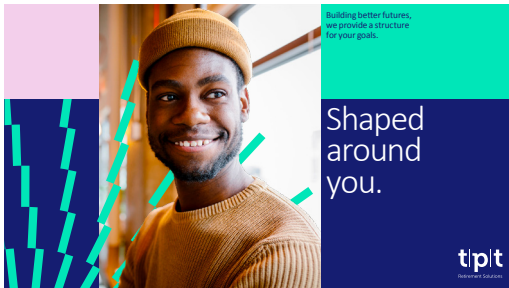
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Layout example



DC

Layout example



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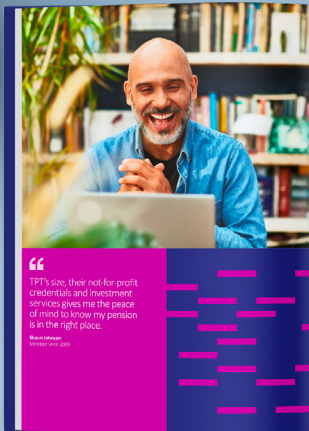
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“

TPT's size, their not-for-profit credentials and investment services gives me the peace of mind to know my pension is in the right place.

Shawn Johnson
Member since 2009

We are and have always been a not-for-profit organisation with no shareholders, operating purely for the benefit of our members. Already one of the UK's leading providers, we provide workplace pensions to all employers across all sectors.

Building better futures, we provide a structure for your goals. Ut et pla dignate moditio. Ribus. Nam, tem. Quij anupic te volent, quam, es etu este cui, lorem te sus, quic neri dolonac assumendum, vhecus.

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Subheadline

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£10.3b

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TPE Annual Report 2020

Pension funds
shaped around you

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Modeling

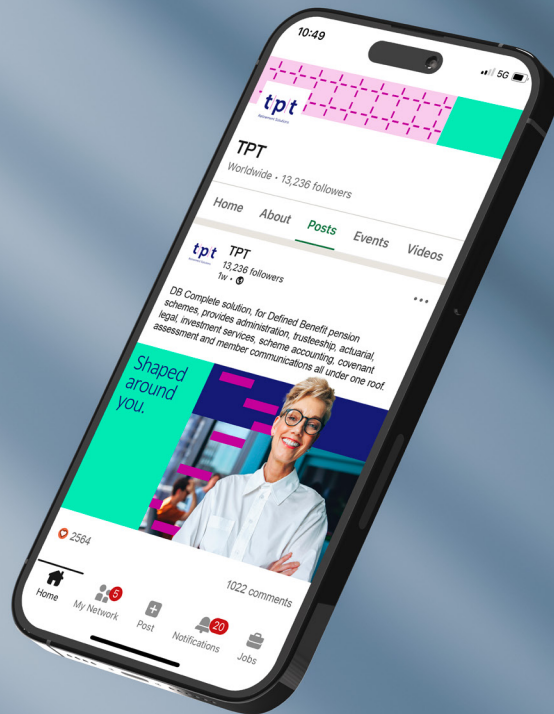
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[Study-Drive.com](#)

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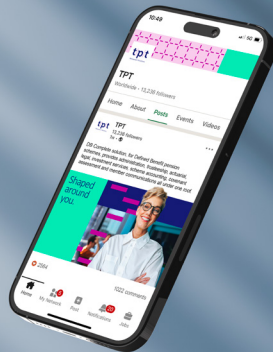
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To reflect our position as the pension industry's leading authority, with unrivalled knowledge and over 75+ years experience, we should always speak with confidence and clarity.

Embodying the TPT brand we must speak with integrity and the language used should be inclusive and customer-focused. This means being transparent, approachable and avoiding jargon wherever possible.

Overall, the reader should always feel that they are dealing with a professional, dedicated and innovative organisation – one they can trust to deliver the solutions needed to define the future they want

When referenced within documents the new name should appear TPT Retirement Solutions initially and then TPT thereafter.

TPT should always appear in uppercase when referenced as 'TPT Retirement Solutions'.

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Who are we?

TPT should always be described in the same way. As we grow as a brand, and come into contact with new customers and publishers, it ensures that we are described correctly and that what we do is never in doubt.

Brand overview

Established in 1946, TPT Retirement Solutions is one of the UK's leading workplace pension schemes, serving over 2,600 organisations and c.400,000 members. The business is run as a not-for-profit organisation for the benefit of its members, and has assets of more than £14 billion.

TPT offers a complete range of defined benefit and defined contribution pension solutions, providing all that is required to run a trust-based scheme, including actuarial, administration, covenant, independent trustee, investment and legal services.

Brand mission

To make membership worthwhile.

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Brand values

To help us achieve our mission, we work to a set of six values:

Committed

We are engaged.

We keep promises and meet our customers' expectations.

We are persistent in our pursuit of success.

Cost effective

We always look for good use of resources.

We budget fairly and robustly.

We act competitively.

Customer focused

We offer a very high level of service.

We listen to and learn from our customers.

We are friendly, approachable, supportive, understanding and responsive.

Inclusive

We establish partnerships with customers.

We embrace diversity in all that we do.

We work towards one goal and one vision.

Innovative

We challenge current processes or traditional methods.

We act pro-actively and creatively.

We encourage and accept new ideas.

Integrity

We consider the interests of others and respect their views.

We are fair in all of our dealings.

We offer the option of ethical investments.

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Key messages

- We're one of the UK's leading providers of workplace pensions;
- We offer an award-winning, consolidated service;
- We look after c.400,000 members through over 2,600 organisations;
- We have 75+ years' experience, with around £14 billion in assets under management;
- We're a not-for-profit organisation with no shareholders. We're run purely for our members;
- We have heritage and scale, so you know you're in safe hands.

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Our language

The words we use reflect what we're like as a company and how people feel about us.

At TPT, we want to be clear, helpful and approachable, making it as simple as possible for members and employers to deal with us. So our communications need to be clear, helpful and approachable. Although our communications often cover complex topics, it's important to remember that the clearer we are, the more likely we are to capture and engage our audience.

Here's how we can make sure our brand values are built into everything we communicate.

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Our language

Jargon

No one really understands it, customers could end up being confused about what you are saying and your brand could easily be undermined.

If there's no way round it and you have to use a technical word or phrase, follow it with a clear explanation. For example:

"You have a final salary scheme. This means that the money available to you when you retire is based on your final salary at the time you retire, or are close to retiring. The formula to work out how much you will receive depends on your scheme and its rules. But the calculation will usually be based on your final pensionable salary, the years of service you have and a fraction, such as 1/60, 1/80 or 1/120. This type of pension scheme is also known as a defined benefit scheme."

Keep it natural

Whenever possible, use language you would use every day. Write the way you might talk. When was the last time you used the word 'cannot' when chatting to a friend? You'd use 'can't'.

Of course, we shouldn't get too familiar - pensions are still a very important topic. So aim for approachable, rather than chummy.

If you get the chance, find a quiet corner and read what you've written out loud. It will quickly highlight any words or phrases that sound stilted or forced.

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Adapt your voice

Different documents can sometimes require different writing styles. A member booklet or administration guide is different to writing, say, a letter or an email. They can all still be engaging and friendly, while providing the information the customer needs.

For example:

“A copy of your latest statement is enclosed. Please contact our Administration team if you have any queries.”

Becomes:

“Here is your latest statement. It should all be straightforward, but if you have any questions, a member of our team will be more than happy to help.”

Finally, regardless of what you were taught at school, it is fine to begin a sentence with ‘and’, ‘but’ and ‘because’. It makes the writing more conversational. And it’s a great way to add emphasis. See?

Switch the pace

Sometimes you’ll have to write a sentence that’s a little bit lengthy. That’s fine - just remember to throw in shorter, punchier sentences to break up the flow. Like this. Or this. It helps keep the reader’s attention.

Take your time

Don’t squeeze everything you want to say into one big paragraph. It will sound messy and can be confusing. Plan before you write, listing everything you want to say in the communication. Keep it to one thought, one sentence.

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Be honest

Pensions are a serious business. So we have a duty to be honest and transparent with our customers at all times. We are here to inform. Never over claim, understate or resort to buzzwords. Be up front, open and clear at all times.

Know your audience

You always need to take your audience into consideration. Ask yourself:

- Will they understand the information you're presenting to them?
- What's important to them?
- What do they need to know?
- Is this going to improve the service we provide to our customer? Is it clear what we are asking them to do?

You can ask a colleague to read your communication and explain the messages back to you. By doing this, you can see whether they understand everything you've written and if anything needs explaining in a different way.

Pensions aren't everything

It's worth remembering that your reader isn't sitting around, eagerly waiting to read your letter, guide or website. They're busy with their jobs, family, friends, running their day-to-day business, and what you are telling them is part of a bigger communications picture.

Your communications and tone of voice should recognise this. You're trespassing on their precious time. So keep your copy bright and accessible.

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Structure and signposting

What you say is one thing. Structuring your letters, emails or reports well is also vital if you want your message to be understood. When you're planning your communication, have a think about these four specific areas as you plan:

Heading	Keep it short, keep it simple, keep it relevant. We want something that the reader understands, so they want to read on.
Actions / summary	What does the reader need to do - fill in a form, speak to someone from TPT? Explain what they need to do up front, so they are clear about their next steps. It's also a good idea to explain, succinctly, why they need to take action. Provide a short summary of what we're telling them and why it's important.
Basic	If it's a long communication it might be best to explain in simple terms in the first instance and then go into more detailed information.
Detailed	Sometimes we need to provide all the detail. The technical bits and everything. If that's the case, let's do it, as simply as possible and with references to any online resources for further information of explanations.

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Structure and signposting

To help us achieve this, we have a set of values that give clarity to our purpose and guidance for our actions:

Bullet points

These can be extremely useful when giving a quick snapshot of a topic. They should be used sparingly, otherwise it can look a bit daunting.

Use a dash for all bullets..

- example bullet
- example bullet
- example bullet

Bulleted lists - each bullet starts lowercase and ends with a semi colon.

The second to last bullet might end with a semi colon and 'and/or'.

The last bullet ends with a full stop.

- example sentence;
- example sentence; and/or
- example sentence.

For bulleted sentences - each bullet starts with a capital letter and ends with a full stop.

- Example sentence.

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Words and phrases transformed

Just because we understand a technical term, it doesn't mean our contacts will.

Here are a few words and phrases that might stop a customer in their tracks – and some alternatives that will make the communication clearer and more natural:

Instead of...

according to our records
amongst
anticipate
as regards
assist
per annum
annually
bienniel
cease/cessation
commence
endeavour
expedite
herewith
inception
in conjunction with

Try...

our records show
expect, predict, think
about, on the subject
help
a year
yearly
every two years
end, finish, stop
start, begin
try
hurry, speed up
with this
start, beginning
and, together with

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Words and phrases transformed

Instead of...

indicate
in lieu of
in the majority of instances
particulars
proceed
procure
provided that
reside
spouse

supplementary
terminate
thereafter
utilise
with a view to
you are requested to
your attention is drawn

Try...

show, suggest, point
instead of
most, mostly, most of the time on the occasion this time
details, facts
go ahead, move ahead
arrange, find, get
if, as long as
live
husband or wife, partner
(except if it's a set term, such as spouse's pension)
extra
end, stop
after that, then, afterwards
use
so that, to
please
please see, please note

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Words and phrases transformed

Lower and upper case examples

Here are some examples of where (and where not) to use initial capitals:

- | | |
|--|---|
| — a career average scheme | — State Pension age |
| — actuary | — Stakeholder Pension |
| — Annual allowance application form | — the board |
| — Corporate Trustee | — the CARE Scheme |
| — defined benefit (DB) | — the Scheme
(if referring to a specific scheme) |
| — defined contribution (DC) | — the scheme
(if talking about schemes in general) |
| — Independent Financial Advisor (IFA) | — TPT Retirement Solutions |
| — Protected Pension Age | — the Trustee Board |
| — Social Housing Pension Scheme (SHPS) | — your scheme |
| — S2P additional State Pension (known as the State Second Pension) | |
| — basic State Pension | |

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Good housekeeping

Once you have your content and your tone of voice, it's worth checking to make sure everything else meets TPT brand voice.

Once you have your content and your tone of voice, it's worth checking to make sure everything else meets TPT brand voice.

Abbreviations

Avoid using abbreviations in text, if possible, except where there is a limited amount of space (for example, in table headings). Where abbreviations are necessary, always write the name in full in the first instance. After that you can put the abbreviation in brackets. For abbreviated initials e.g. UK or NB, full stops should not be used. Where Co and Ltd are present as part of the company name, full stops should not be used.

- defined benefit (DB);
- career average revalued earnings (CARE);
- defined contribution (DC); and
- The Social Housing Pension Scheme (SHPS/the Scheme).

Please note: where abbreviations are appropriate, abbreviate a name after the first mention i.e. defined benefit (DB), and then abbreviate throughout the remainder of the document.

Acronyms

In main body copy, the full name should always be written in full the first time, followed by the acronym in brackets. Again, no full stops should be used. For example, State Earnings Related Pension Scheme (SERPS).

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Apostrophes

- The member's birth certificate – the certificate belongs to one member.
- The members' records – the records belong to more than one member.
- Women's rights – this is a plural irregular noun and therefore an apostrophe precedes the 's'.
- Mr Bridges' house – when it indicates a possessive and the possessor's name ends in an 'iz' sound, the apostrophe is not followed by 's'.
- In one week's/two weeks' time – this is possessive, in the time of one week.
- The summer of '69 – this is a contraction of the full date 1969
- It's/its – It's is the abbreviation for it is or it has, as in, 'Oh dear, it's raining!' or 'It's been a good day.'

- Its is used when it is a possessive adjective and then it doesn't stand for it is or it has, for example, 'the British food at its best.'

Addresses

Address details should always be written in full unless space does not permit this. Where a street number is followed by a letter, it should be written in lower case. No comma should be included before the street name e.g. 15a Canal Wharf. County names should not be abbreviated.

Amperstands

Amperstands (&) should only be used if present as part of a company name or where two addressees are present.

- Marks & Spencer; or
- Mr & Mrs Smith.

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Brackets (full stops)

Where brackets are used within a sentence, the full stop should go outside the bracket. i.e.

- Employer application form(please sign and return to TPT).
- Where the full sentence is inside the brackets the full stop should go inside the bracket. For example:
- Employer application form.
(Please sign and return to TPT.)

Capital letters

Capital letters should only be used to begin a sentence and for specific product and fund names, for example, Growth Plan Series 3, and proper nouns. They should be used for specific job titles, for example, “TPT Chief Executive Mike Ramsey”, but not for general references to roles such as actuary.

Commas

The use of commas is generally divided into two categories. Firstly, commas are inserted where natural breaks in the text flow occur. This can be thought of as where one might take a breath if the text was being read aloud. However, don't be scared of using full stops. Short sentences are good. They help you make a point.

Secondly, commas may be used when listing items. For example, you can nominate your spouse, civil partner, a child and anyone who is financially dependent on you (please note that a comma is not used before the final list item).

Dates

Dates should be written as 28 October 2009 so please don't use st, nd, rd, th. And always include the whole year, rather than '09.

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Email and web addresses

All email addresses and websites should be recorded in lower case letters, for example, web@tpt.org.uk.

Exempli gratia

In formal settings 'e.g.' should be avoided wherever possible. Instead use 'for example' or 'such as'. Where this abbreviation is necessary, full stops should always be inserted after each letter.

Gender specific language

The use of gender-specific language such as him/her or his/hers should be avoided. 'They' should be used instead, or a person should be referred to by name. There is one exception. If the contact person is unknown, the salutation should always read Dear Sir/ Madam.

The word 'spouse' only refers to married couples. It cannot be applied to same sex partners, which should be referred to as legal spouse or civil partner.

Hyphenations

Hyphens are used to link words and parts of words. There are three main reasons to use them:

- when you have joined two words together to describe something, for example, long-term or newly introduced;
- to join prefixes to other words; and
- to show word breaks.

ID EST

As with e.g., the use of i.e. should be avoided in formal running text. Instead use phrases such as in other words or meaning that.

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Job titles

Job titles should be written in capital letters when referring to a specific person or role, for example, TPT Chief Executive Mike Ramsey, or 'members of The Trustee Board'.

Lower case should be used when roles are mentioned generally, such as, 'the directors' or 'the board met to discuss...'.

Numbers

Numbers between one and nine should always be written out in letters; 10 and above in figures. There are of course exceptions, such as:

- Groups of figures: They are expecting between 6 and 19 people to apply.
- Numbers at the beginning of sentences: Twelve guides have been delivered.
- Percentages: We recorded a 5% increase in profits (please note no

decimal places should be included for exact figures unless required for table alignment or to keep figures consistent if others are displayed in the same document to more decimal places).

- Where numbers exceed 999 a comma should be inserted after the thousands and millions e.g. we refunded £14,000 to the member.
- Abbreviations should not be used for million or billion and a space should precede either word e.g. £9 million.
- Fractions should be spelled out e.g. one and a half or three sixths.

Quotations

When citing references from a document, single quotation marks should be used.

Where making reference to spoken words, speech marks should be inserted.

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A final check

So, you've written a clear and concise, warm and engaging communication to a customer. Now what? Well, there's always time for a final check. But before that, go and have a cup of tea. Then come back with a fresh pair of eyes and see if you can answer yes to these questions.

- Is the reason for writing clear from the beginning?
- Is the language natural and conversational?
- Will the customer know exactly what they need to do after reading?
- Is all the important information summed up somewhere?
- Does the writing have pace and rhythm?
- Has any jargon been replaced with straightforward language?
- Do the sub-heads sum up the next paragraph?
- Have any bullet points been used sparingly?

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- ↳ Icons

Imagery

- ↳ General principles
- ↳ Hero photography
- ↳ Supporting photography

Sub-brands

- ↳ DB Connect
- ↳ DC
- ↳ Overview

In application

Tone of voice

Contact

Contact

We hope these guidelines explain everything you need to implement this brand refresh with confidence.

If you have any questions or enquiries about our brand identity, please contact **marketing@tpt.org.uk**